

AFTER KOHLI

The scheduled Indian **tour** of England for a Test series **was eagerly** awaited by cricket fans for a special reason. It was supposed to be the last **outing** for Rohit Sharma and Virat Kohli in **whites** for India.

Instead, an anti-climax has **unfolded** for the fans with the twin retirements of the **veterans**. A few days after Rohit Sharma announced his **departure** from Test cricket, Kohli **followed suit** — much to the **chagrin** of his long **legion** of fans. The **King** of Red-Ball Cricket **has** brought an **abrupt** end to his fans' dreams, putting a question mark on the popularity of the upcoming series.

It is not an **exaggeration** but a simple fact that **Test cricket**, especially **featuring** India, **had** the big advantage of Virat Kohli's presence in the middle. He was a brand, sitting much above his **contemporaries who** had equal talent but never could match the aura of Kohli. The former India **skipper** was a **magnet** that attracted fans to the longer version despite the **onslaught** of Twenty20 leagues **round-the-clock**.

With Brand Kohli missing, cricket in whites has a new challenge of attracting audience. It is also a challenge for the sponsors and marketers to find another Virat Kohli who could keep the heart of Test cricket beating in rhythm.

Kohli had a special love for Test cricket, something he had **inherited** from his mentor and idol Sachin Tendulkar. His game **bloomed** on **classicism** that cricket in whites **bestows on** its real lovers. Even in the shorter formats, Kohli relied heavily on **orthodox** strokes while occasionally choosing the **slam-bang** as per the need of the situation. It helped him **immensely** in all formats as Test cricket found its beat in Kohli's **expansive** cover drives. It **drew hordes** back to the stadium.

He had been the face of red ball cricket for almost a **decade**. All of a sudden he has quit, leaving the administrators, fans and fellow players to **brood on** the future without heartbeat.

Kohli was a **cushion** for the longest format of the game. He could **lure** sponsors and investors to red-ball cricket when white-ball was making all the commercial statements with **mushrooming** of newer leagues. Among his contemporaries like Joe Root and Steve Smith, Kohli **stood at a higher pedestal** for the magic he created with his **passionate** show in whites. It **resulted in** the marketers focusing totally on **the Delhi batsman** to sell the product.

None had thought of looking beyond Kohli. In fact, they did not have a choice to look beyond the former India captain — as there was (and is) **hardly** a player who could **evoke** the same **sentiment**.

When Tendulkar retired, the administrators and sponsors had Kohli to **fall back upon**. Now, in the post-Kohli era, the challenge looks **daunting**. New-age cricketers are still **finding their footing** in the international **arena**. The **success** of T20 cricket **has** made it difficult for them to concentrate on Tests. The Gills, Pants, and Bumrahs are stars, but none is like Kohli the superstar. **[Practice Exercise]**

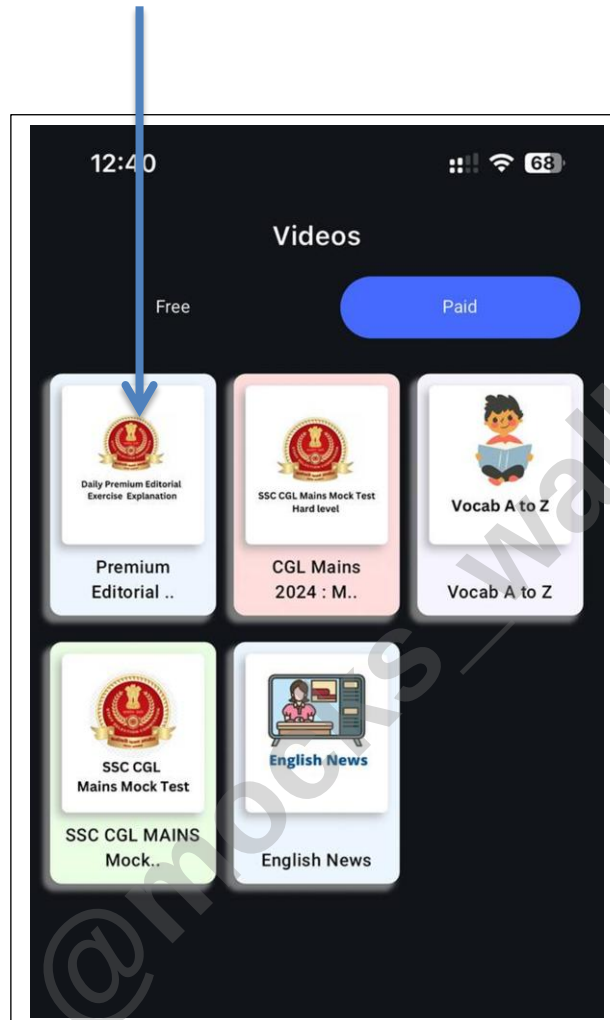
- Red/blue coloring of words in the sentence indicates subject verb relationship; where 'red' denotes 'subject' and 'blue' denotes 'verb'.

Vocabulary

1. **Eagerly** (adverb) – excitedly, enthusiastically, keenly, earnestly, impatiently उत्सुकता से
2. **Outing** (noun) – trip, excursion, expedition, tour, venture दौरा
3. **White** (noun) – Test cricket, red-ball cricket, longer format, whites (cricket attire), classic cricket टेस्ट क्रिकेट (संदर्भ में)
4. **Unfold** (verb) – happen, occur, develop, reveal, emerge प्रकट होना
5. **Veteran** (noun) – experienced player, senior, old-timer, expert, stalwart अनुभवी खिलाड़ी
6. **Departure** (noun) – exit, retirement, withdrawal, leaving, resignation विदाई
7. **Follow suit** (phrase) – do the same, imitate, replicate, copy, follow अनुसरण करना
8. **Chagrin** (noun) – disappointment, distress, dismay, sorrow, annoyance दुख
9. **Legion** (noun) – multitude, mass, army, crowd, throng भारी संख्या
10. **Abrupt** (adjective) – sudden, unexpected, unanticipated, hasty, quick अचानक
11. **Exaggeration** (noun) – overstatement, hyperbole, amplification, magnification, embellishment बढ़ा-चढ़ाकर कही गई बात
12. **Feature** (verb) – include, present, display, star, highlight प्रमुख रूप से दिखना
13. **Contemporary** (noun) – peer, equal, counterpart, coeval, fellow समकालीन व्यक्ति
14. **Skipper** (noun) – captain, leader, commander, head, chief कप्तान
15. **Magnet** (noun) – attraction, draw, lure, charm, pull आकर्षण
16. **Onslaught** (noun) – attack, assault, barrage, invasion, deluge आक्रमण
17. **Round-the-clock** (adjective) – continuous, nonstop, 24/7, unceasing, relentless चौबीसों घंटे
18. **Inherit** (verb) – receive, derive, gain, obtain, acquire विरासत में पाना
19. **Bloom** (verb) – flourish, thrive, prosper, blossom, grow उभरना
20. **Classicism** (noun) – tradition, purity, formality, orthodoxy, elegance शैली, अंदाज़
21. **Bestow** (on) (verb) – grant, offer, present, confer, endow प्रदान करना
22. **Orthodox** (noun) – traditionalist, conventionalist, conformist, purist, conservative परंपरागत तरीका
23. **Slam-bang** (noun) – aggressive play, explosive shots, power-hitting, spectacle, hard-hitting तेज़ और जोरदार खेल

24. **Immensely** (adverb) – greatly, enormously, hugely, vastly, significantly अत्यधिक
25. **Expansive** (adjective) – wide, broad, sweeping, extensive, elaborate फैला हुआ / खुला
26. **Draw** (verb) – attract, pull, entice, lure, bring in आकर्षित करना
27. **Horde** (noun) – crowd, throng, mob, mass, multitude भीड़
28. **Decade** (noun) – Period of ten years, दशक
29. **Brood** (on) (verb) – dwell on, worry about, contemplate, think deeply, ponder चिंतन करना / परेशान होना
30. **Cushion** (noun) – support, protection, safeguard, buffer, padding सहारा
31. **Lure** (verb) – attract, entice, tempt, draw, coax लुभाना
32. **Mushroom** (verb) – grow rapidly, spread, multiply, expand, proliferate तेजी से बढ़ना
33. **Stand at a pedestal** (phrase) – be highly respected, be admired, hold a high position, be above others ऊँचे स्थान पर होना
34. **Passionate** (adjective) – intense, emotional, fervent, enthusiastic, devoted जुनूनी
35. **Result** (in) (verb) – lead to, cause, bring about, produce, generate परिणामस्वरूप होना
36. **The Delhi batsman** (noun) – refers to Virat Kohli दिल्ली का बल्लेबाज़
37. **Hardly** (adverb) – scarcely, barely, rarely, seldom, infrequently शायद ही
38. **Evoke** (verb) – arouse, bring forth, provoke, stir, awaken जगाना
39. **Sentiment** (noun) – feeling, emotion, view, opinion, mood भावना
40. **Fall back upon** (phrase) – rely on, depend on, resort to, turn to, use as backup सहारा लेना
41. **Daunting** (adjective) – intimidating, overwhelming, discouraging, frightening, challenging कठिन
42. **Find one's footing** (phrase) – establish oneself, gain stability, adjust, settle in, become confident जमना / स्थिरता पाना
43. **Arena** (noun) – field, domain, sphere, platform, stage क्षेत्र

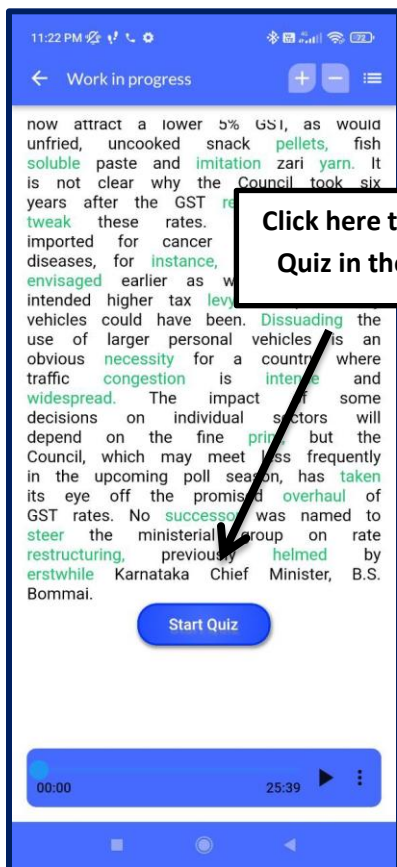
Video solution of Practice Exercise from this Editorial is exclusively available on App.



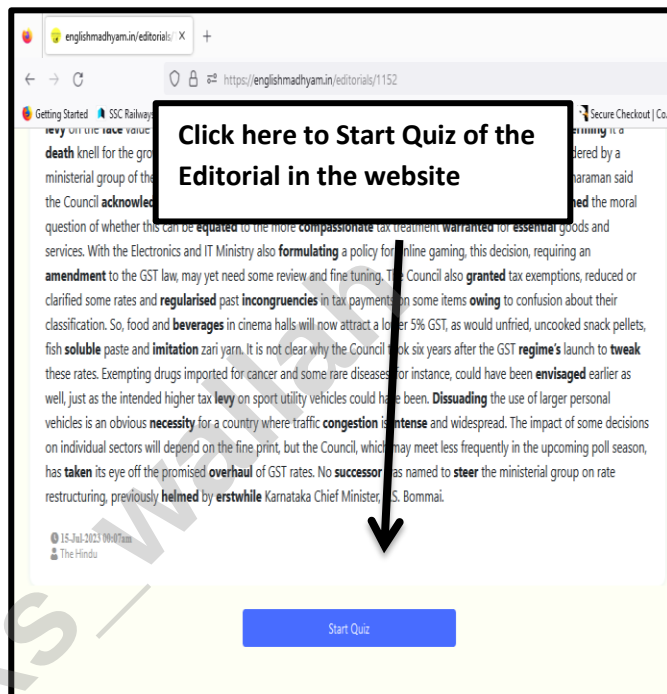
Summary of the Editorial

1. The upcoming India-England Test series was highly anticipated as the farewell series for **Virat Kohli and Rohit Sharma**.
2. Fans faced disappointment as both veterans **announced their retirement from Test cricket** before the series began.
3. Virat Kohli's sudden exit has **dampened interest** and excitement for the series among cricket lovers.
4. Kohli was a **central figure in Test cricket**, particularly for India, drawing immense attention and viewership.
5. His **brand power and charisma** elevated the stature of Test cricket amid the popularity of T20 leagues.
6. Kohli's absence now leaves a **void in audience engagement**, impacting the marketing and commercial side of Test cricket.
7. He had a **deep passion for Test cricket**, inspired by his mentor Sachin Tendulkar.
8. Kohli's **classical batting style**, especially his elegant cover drives, captivated fans and upheld the spirit of Test cricket.
9. For nearly a decade, Kohli was the **face of red-ball cricket**, balancing commercial appeal and traditional technique.
10. His exit has left **fans, administrators, and players** concerned about the future of Test cricket without a major crowd-puller.
11. Kohli was a **commercial magnet**, drawing sponsors and investors even when T20 formats dominated the market.
12. Compared to other greats like **Joe Root and Steve Smith**, Kohli had a more **commanding global fan base and marketing value**.
13. Cricket marketers heavily **relied on Kohli** to sell Test cricket as a product; no serious effort was made to build another icon.
14. Unlike Kohli after Tendulkar, the current crop of stars like **Shubman Gill, Rishabh Pant, and Jasprit Bumrah**, though talented, lack his iconic stature.
15. The editorial concludes that in this **post-Kohli era**, Test cricket faces a daunting challenge to find a new superstar who can keep its soul alive.

Practice Exercise: SSC Pattern Based



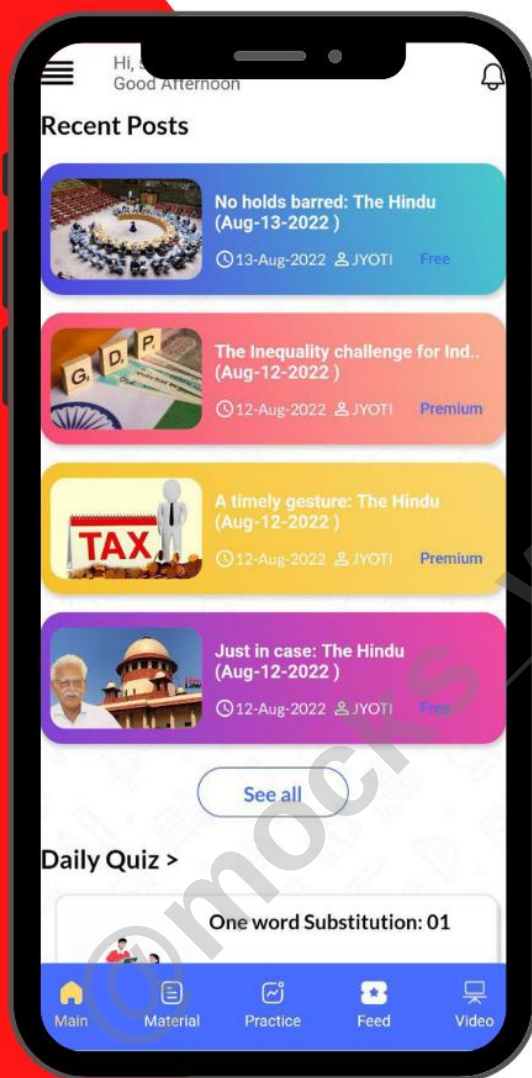
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